

Orientation Portal

A web-based intake system that allows program participants to complete orientation paperwork online, ahead of time. Participants fill out required forms, provide digital signatures, and upload necessary documents through a simple web interface. On submission, everything is packaged into a single zip file and emailed directly to staff — nothing is stored on the server.

The Problem

Program orientations required one person to proctor paperwork while another handled computer input. With more than three participants, the process became chaotic — documents were misfiled, signatures missed, and the process took 2-3 hours per person. Non-tech-savvy staff compounded errors under pressure.

The Solution

This system moves the paperwork online and ahead of time. Participants receive a link, complete their forms at home, sign digitally, and upload required documents. Everything arrives at the office pre-organized, correctly named, and ready to process. Orientation time drops from 2-3 hours to approximately 30 minutes per person.

Features

- Digital form completion with validation (catches errors before submission)
- Signature capture (works on phone, tablet, or computer)
- Document upload with automatic file naming
- Everything packaged into a zip and emailed — zero server storage
- Configurable for different programs (swap a config file, get a new portal)

Tech Stack

- **Backend:** Python 3.11+, FastAPI
- **Frontend:** HTML, CSS, vanilla JavaScript
- **PDF Generation:** fpdf2
- **Email:** smtplib (SMTP)
- **Signature Capture:** signature_pad.js

Setup

1. Clone the repository

```
bash
```

```
git clone <your-repo-url>
cd orientation-portal
```

2. Install dependencies

```
bash

pip install -r requirements.txt
```

3. Configure environment

```
bash

copy .env.example .env
# Edit .env with your email server settings
```

4. Run the application

```
bash

uvicorn app.main:app --reload
```

The app will be available at `http://localhost:8000`

Configuring for a New Program

To adapt this portal for a different program:

1. Copy `program_configs/example_program.json`
2. Rename it to your program name (e.g., `new_program.json`)
3. Edit the fields, required documents, and email recipient
4. Update the program name in `config.py`

See `program_configs/example_program.json` for all available options.

Deployment Notes

- No data is stored on the server at any point
- All files are processed in memory and discarded after email delivery
- Suitable for compliance-sensitive environments
- Email delivery requires SMTP access (configure in `.env`)

Results

- Orientation time reduced from 2-3 hours to ~30 minutes per participant
- Document filing errors eliminated through automatic naming
- Staff workload reduced by approximately 10-15 hours per week
- Scalable to multiple concurrent participants without added chaos

Author

Built by [Your Name] — workflow automation and process optimization
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